



Acer's top brass on the brand's gaming laptops and their future!

Sudhir Goel, Chief Business Officer at Acer

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Q How has the demand for gaming laptops changed post the pandemic? We know it went up during the pandemic. Now that people have started going back to work, has there been a change in demand for gaming laptops?

A Gaming was definitely a boost for the IT hardware industry, all brands. And gaming was definitely the start there because as the people got more time, they had ample time for both work from home and entertainment and gaming. Earlier if they were playing on the small screen size, maybe for a couple of hours with the amount of time they had at their disposal, of course, the number of hours they were spending on the gaming increased. And that implied that they had no other option but to switch to a larger screen size. So maybe smartphone based gamers move towards laptop gaming. And hence the demand for the gaming laptops increased globally as well as in India. Having said that, if you talk about generally the laptop industry or the IT hardware industry, I'm sure you would have seen the results which have come in either from the IDC or Gartner, which states the demand has slowed down globally, primarily because of the various macroeco-

nomie factors, as well as all because of the increased demand which happened in the pandemic and a lot of users actually bought it. So, of course, it was liable to come. But at the same time, the gaming is still not impacted. I mean, while the overall consumer laptop demand or for that matter, commercial desktop as well as laptop demand would have grown down, gaming is still growing at a quite good pace. According to the latest study, the overall gaming laptop market is valued at around, let's say, 11 billion dollars. And it's expected that it will grow at the rate of about 5 to 6 percent till, let's say, 2029. So while post-COVID in 2023, overall PC demand has gone down, the laptop demand still continues to be high. And we do expect it to continue to stay at this level as per all. Because a lot of people have started adopting games as a serious gamers. They started migrating from casual gaming to a serious gaming. So obviously, it has helped the gaming laptop market to grow.

Q What is it that you have to do to entice price conscious Indian gamers to purchase a gaming laptop? Is there anything that Acer does that specifically targets Indian gamers?

A If you have to breakdown the gam-

ing user, we can typically break them into three categories. One is obviously the casual gamers. I mean, maybe they are doing it first time or the amount of time that they're spending is less on the games and they will have a price as a consideration. That's one category of the customers which we talk about. There are other people, the second set of customers who are actually serious gamers. They look for, let's say, better performance, better, faster laptop, better graphics, better screen, but they have affordability issues. So I will call it a mid segment listing. And then there are truly serious gamers, you know, for whom the performance of the gaming laptop is paramount for making their buying decision. So you have all the three kinds of segments. And for any brand, it's important to operate in all of those three segments because to capture the gaming laptop market. So we have, of course, different propositions for the different market segments, because I don't think in the Indian market with that kind of a base, one particular solution can fit the demands for everyone. So we have, let's say, on the top of the line, our flagship product Predator, which is, let's say, for the very, very serious gamers who spend a lot of time and